Maal Help

Your Warehouse. Under Control.

USER MANUAL

Inventory Controller

Keeps stock accurate: cycle counts, adjustments, status changes, transfers, batches and serials.

Version 1.0 · 25 October 2026

For Maal Help 1.0

About this manual

Item	Details
Product	Maal Help 1.0: *Your Warehouse. Under Control.*
Manual	Inventory Controller User Manual
Role in the system	Inventory Controller
Version / date	1.0 · 25 October 2026
Screenshots	Captured from the running application with the fictional demo company "ABC Trading & Warehousing"
Demo account for this role	`controller@example.com`. Development/demo environment only. The password is provided by your administrator and is never printed in manuals.

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1 Introduction

Who this manual is for

This manual is for people with the **Inventory Controller** role in Maal Help. Keeps stock accurate: cycle counts, adjustments, status changes, transfers, batches and serials.

Maal Help is a warehouse operating system: stock by warehouse, location, batch and owner on a permanent ledger, plus purchasing, sales and fulfilment, billing, reports and an AI Copilot that answers from your own data.

Your role can

- ✓ Create and perform stock counts
- ✓ Request adjustments and status changes
- ✓ Request and execute transfers; put away
- ✓ View inventory, ledger, batches and serials; operational reports

Your role cannot

- ✗ Approve adjustments or count variances
- ✗ See financial values
- ✗ Create sales or purchase orders

Screens show the fictional demo company **ABC Trading & Warehousing**. Your company's names and numbers will differ. Menus show only what your role is allowed to use.

2 Access and navigation

Signing in

Maal Help runs in any modern browser on a computer, tablet or Android phone. Your company administrator creates your account and gives you a temporary password.

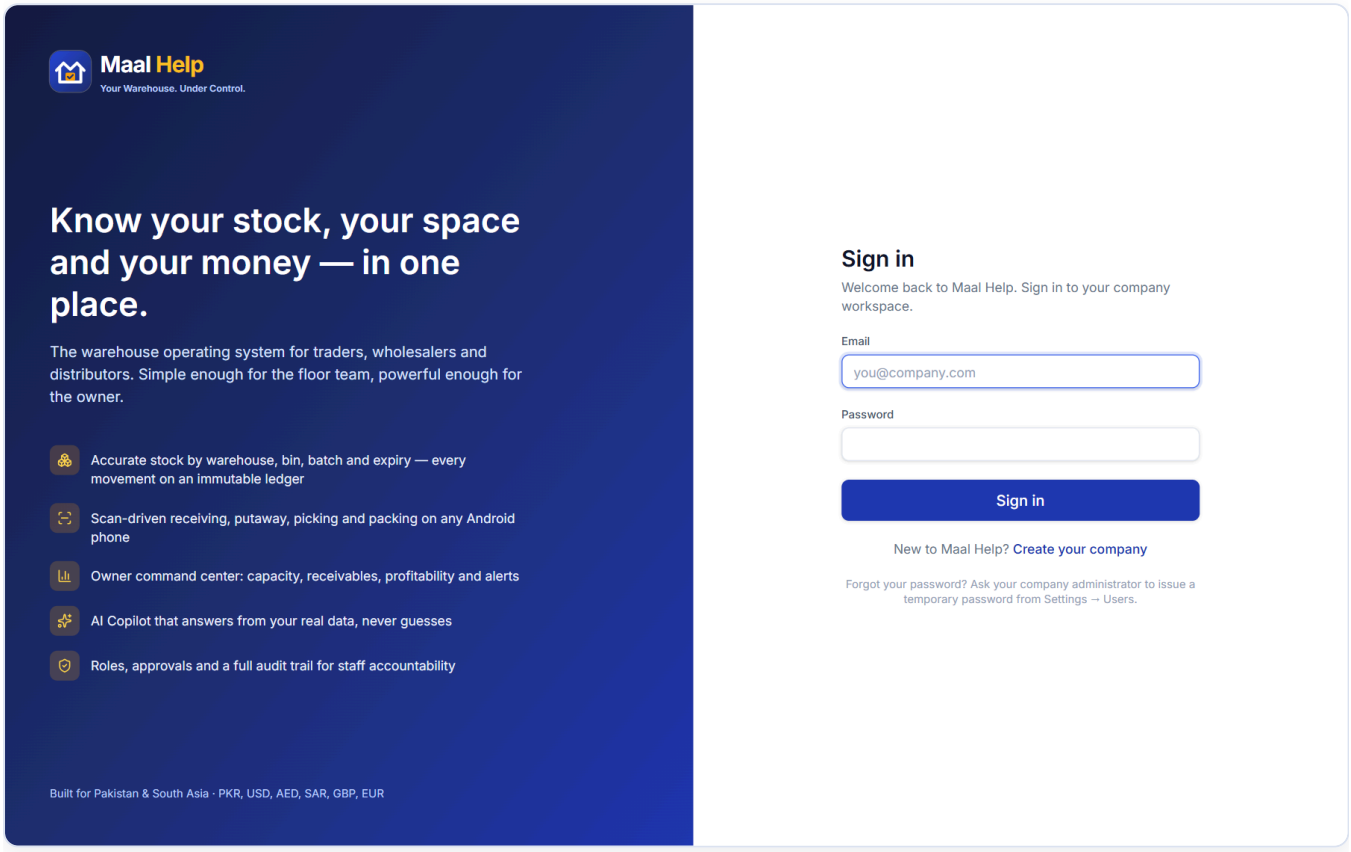


Figure 1. The Maal Help sign-in page.

1. Open the Maal Help address your company gave you.
2. Enter your work email and password, then select **Sign in**.
3. The first time, change your temporary password: **Settings** → **My profile** → **Change password** (at least 10 characters with letters and numbers).
4. Forgot your password? Ask your company administrator to issue a temporary one (**Settings** → **Users** → **Reset password**).

> After 8 wrong passwords the account is locked for a short time. Wait, then try again.

> Sign out on shared computers. Sessions also expire automatically.

Finding your way around

The left sidebar shows only the screens your role may use. Counts next to a menu item (for example Putaway 2) show open work.

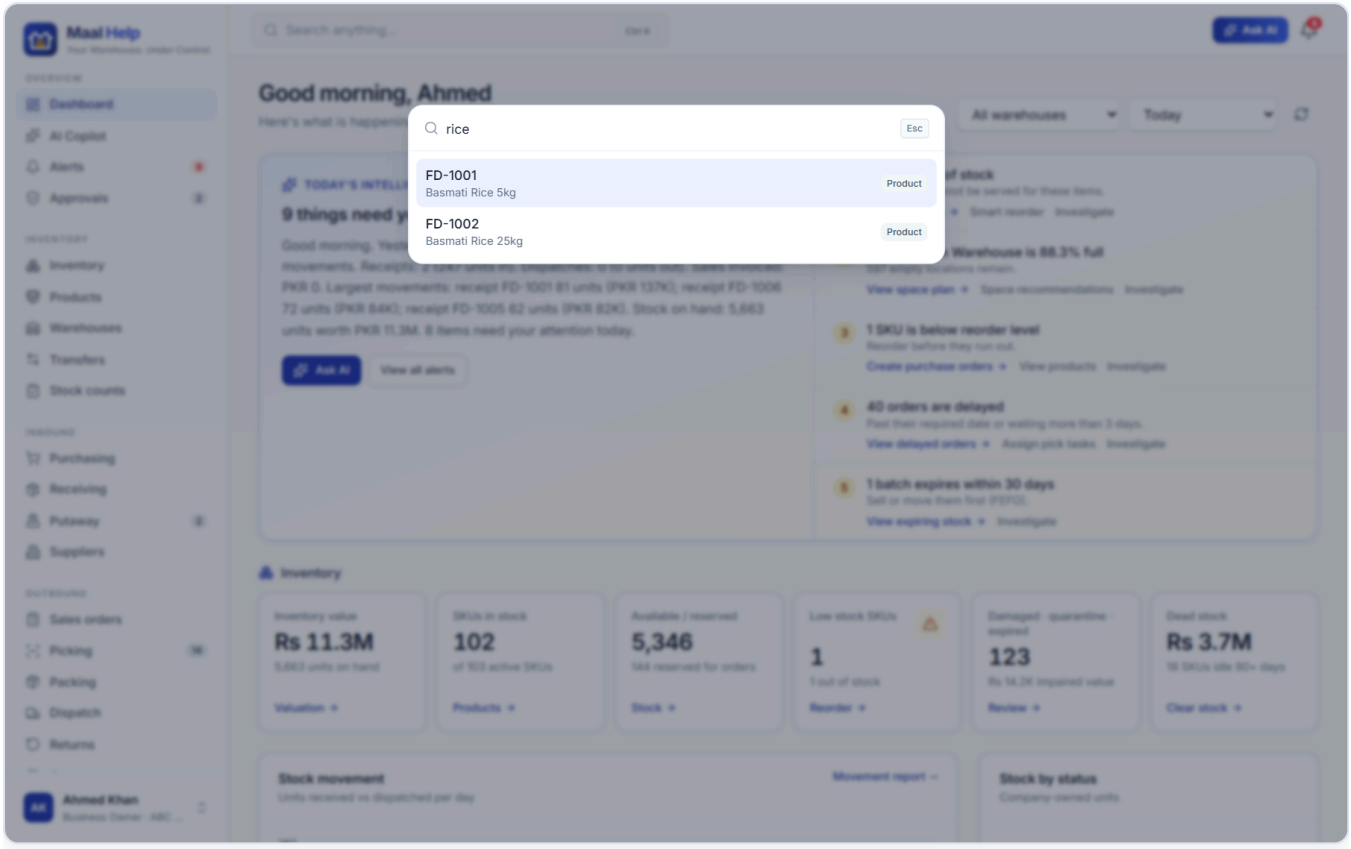


Figure 2. Press Ctrl + K anywhere to search products, orders, customers, locations and screens.

1. Use the **sidebar** to move between screens. Your name and role are at the bottom.
2. Use **Search anything...** at the top, or press **Ctrl + K**, then type a SKU, barcode, order number or name.
3. The **bell** opens your notifications. **Ask AI** opens the Copilot (if your role has it).
4. Tables support search, filters, sorting and paging. Click a row to open the record.

> If a screen or button you expect is missing, your role does not include that permission. Ask your administrator. The server enforces permissions, so hiding a menu is never the only control.

3 Your home screen

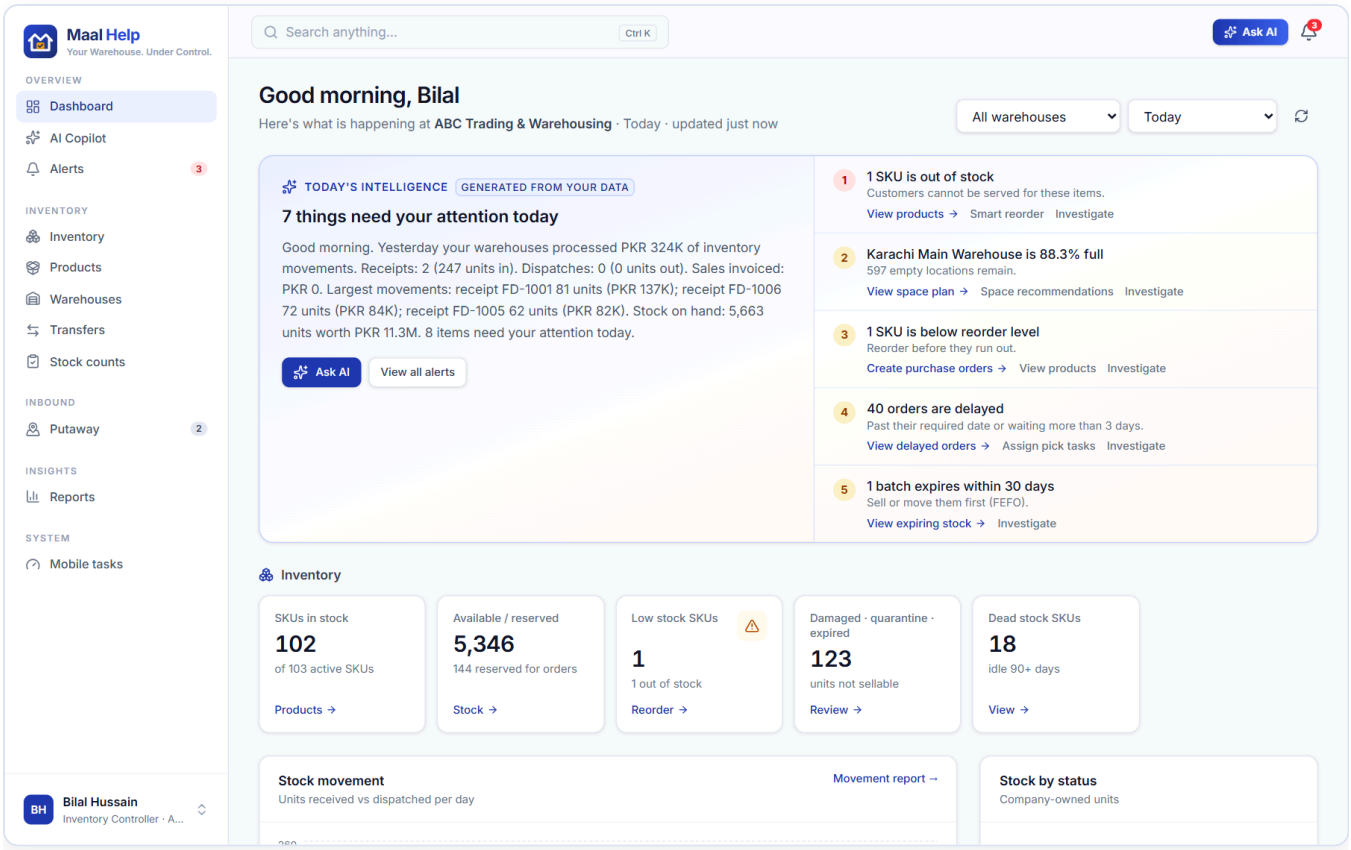


Figure 3. Inventory Controller dashboard.

- Focus on stock health: low and out-of-stock SKUs, expiring batches, damaged/quarantine units, pending adjustments.

4 Features step by step

Inventory: stock on hand and ledger

Every unit, by warehouse, location, batch, owner and status, backed by a ledger that nobody can edit or delete.

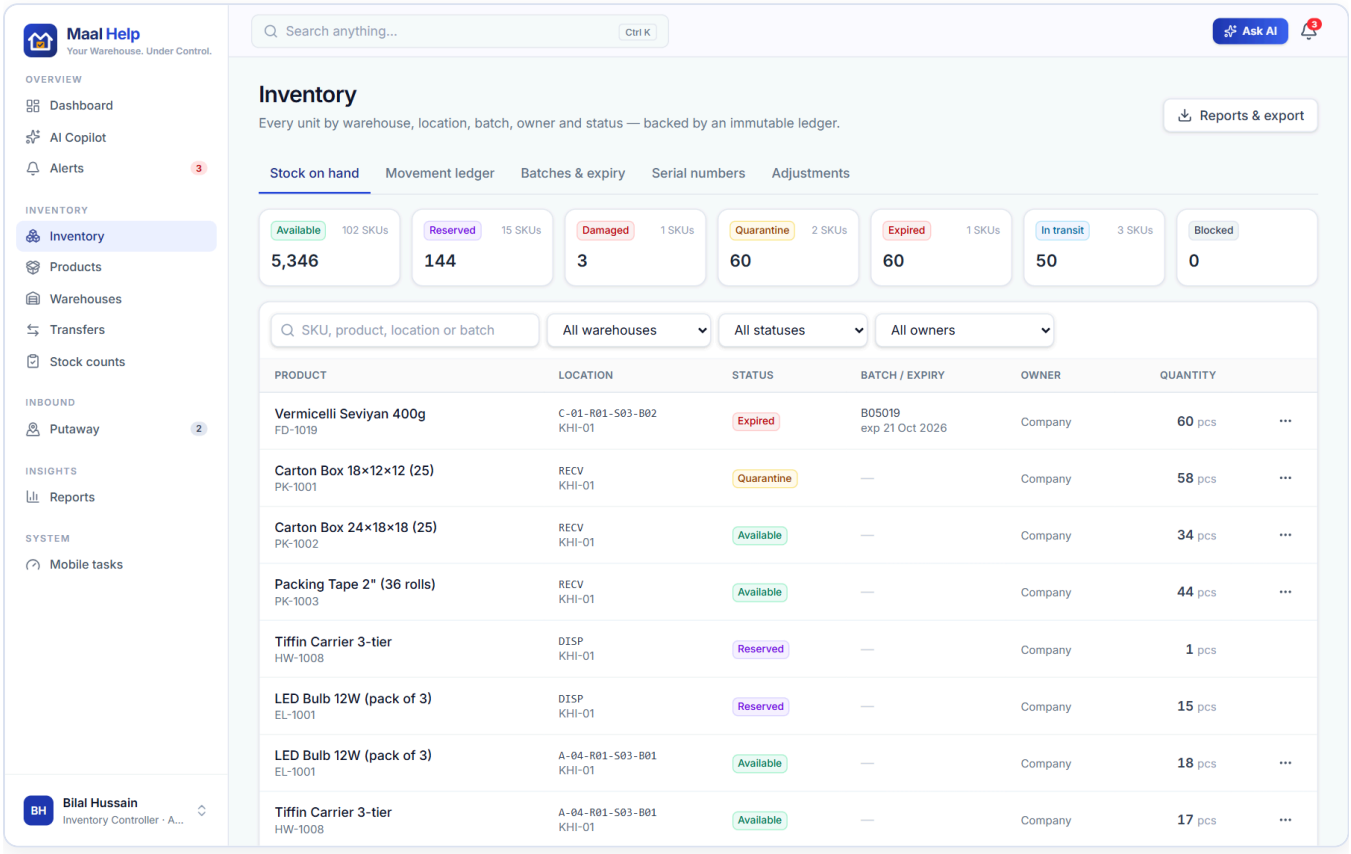


Figure 4. Stock on hand with status totals (Available, Reserved, Damaged, Quarantine, Expired, In transit, Blocked).

1. Open **Inventory**. Click a status card to filter, or search by product, SKU or location.
2. Tabs: **Stock on hand**, **Movement ledger** (every receipt, move, pick, dispatch, adjustment), **Batches & expiry**, **Serial numbers**, **Adjustments**.
3. Click a product to see its stock by location and its full movement history.
4. **Reports & export** opens the matching reports with Excel/CSV/PDF export.

> Stock can never go negative. Corrections are new transactions (adjustments, reversals), never edits.

> Roles without finance access do not see values or costs.

Stock counts

Create a count, assign a counter, count, review the variance, approve and post. Significant variances always need approval.

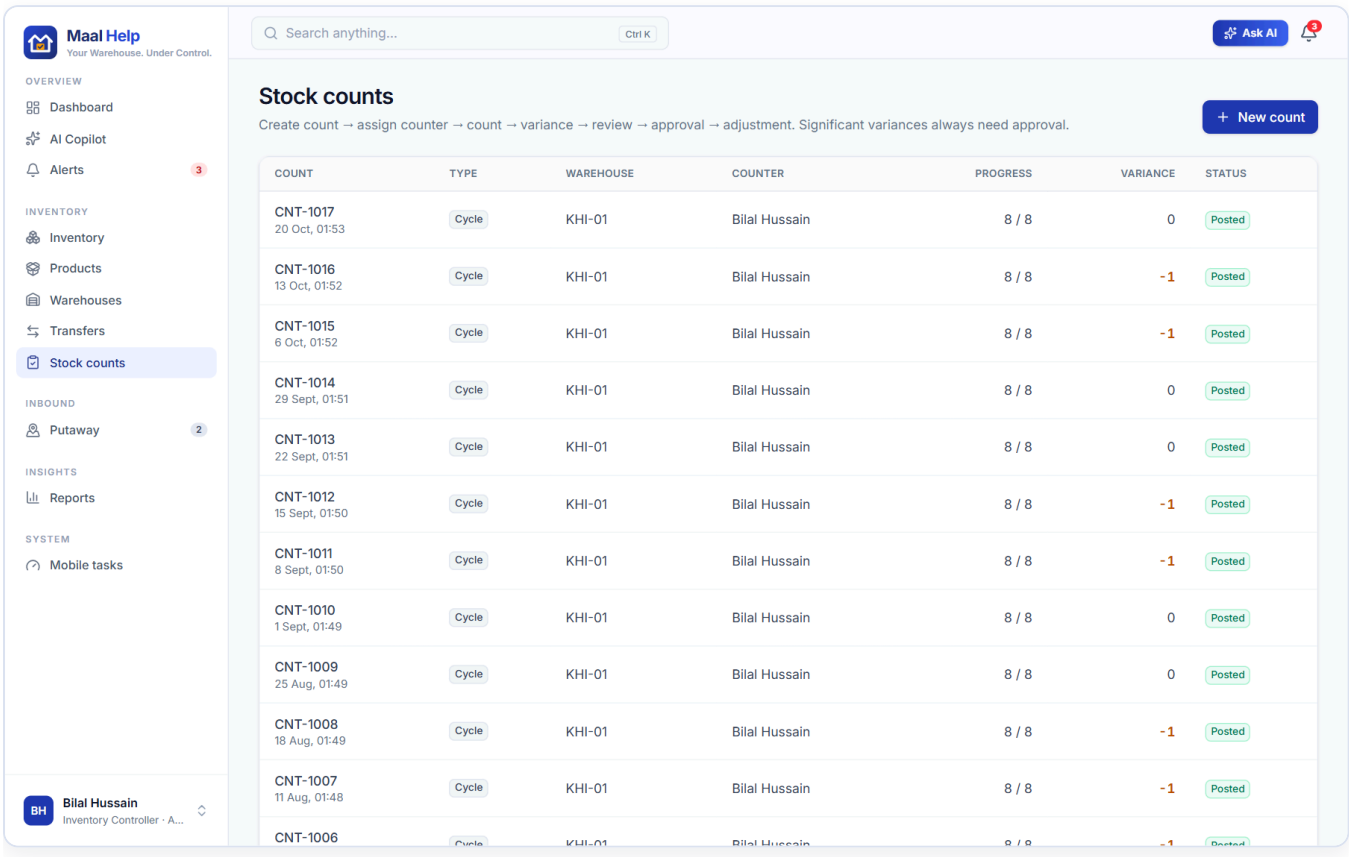


Figure 5. Stock counts with progress and variance.

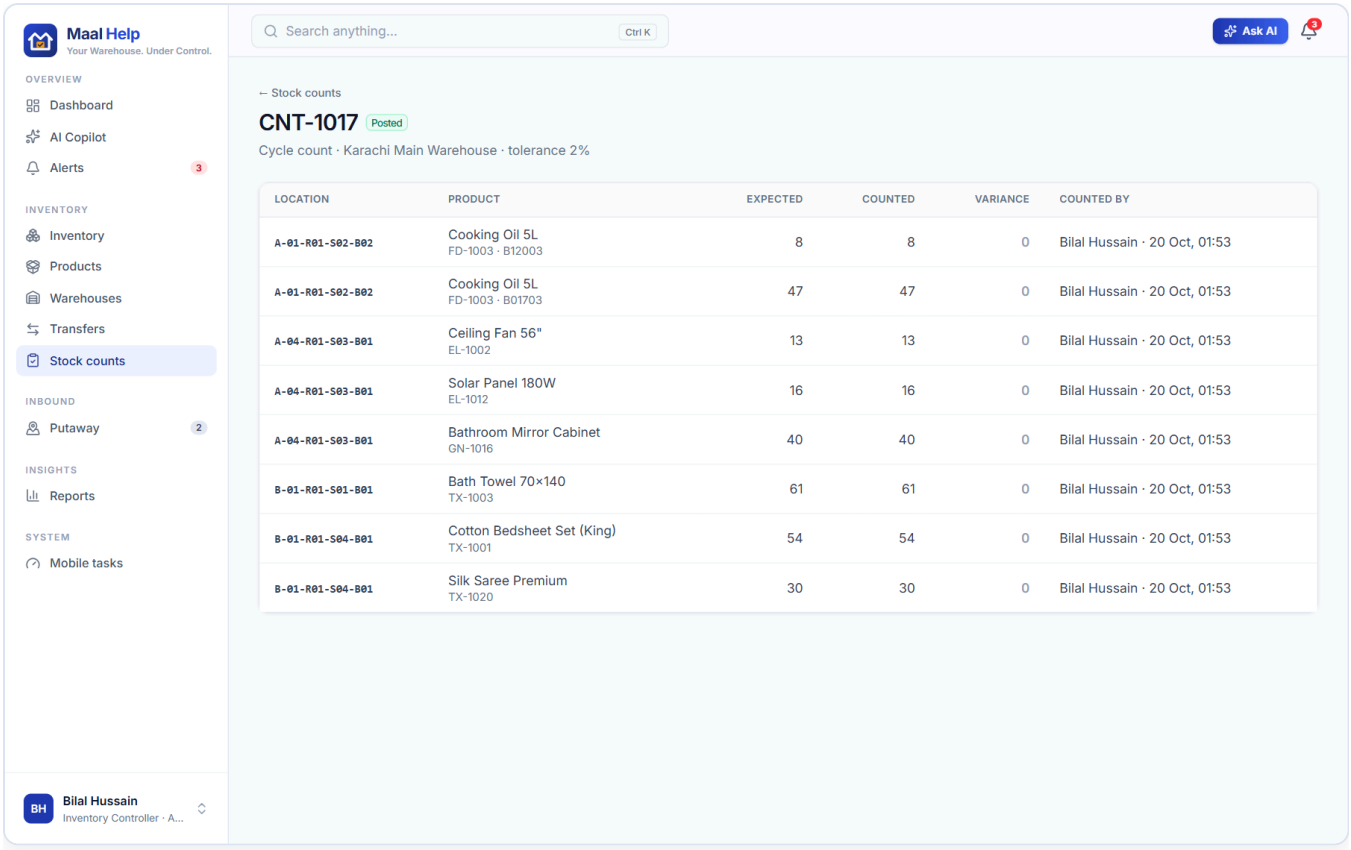


Figure 6. Count lines: expected versus counted.

1. **Stock counts** → **New count**: choose warehouse, type (cycle, full or blind) and scope.
2. Assign a counter. Counters count on the phone (**COUNT**): scan the location, then the product, and enter the counted quantity.
3. Review variances. Lines within tolerance post automatically; larger variances go for approval.
4. On approval, the difference posts as a count adjustment in the ledger.

> In a **blind count** the counter does not see the expected quantity.

> The tolerance % is set in **Settings** → **Inventory, notifications & AI**.

Stock adjustments and status changes

Record damage, loss, found stock or a status change (e.g. to quarantine) with a reason. Large adjustments wait for approval.

1. Open **Inventory**, find the product and location, and choose the adjustment action (or use the **Adjustments** tab).
2. Enter the quantity change (+ or −), a reason code and notes. Attach details in the notes for the approver.
3. If the value exceeds the threshold, the adjustment shows **Pending approval** and nothing changes until it is approved.

> Every adjustment is permanent history. To undo one, post an opposite adjustment with a reason.

Stock transfers

Move stock warehouse to warehouse (with approval and in-transit tracking) or location to location within a site.

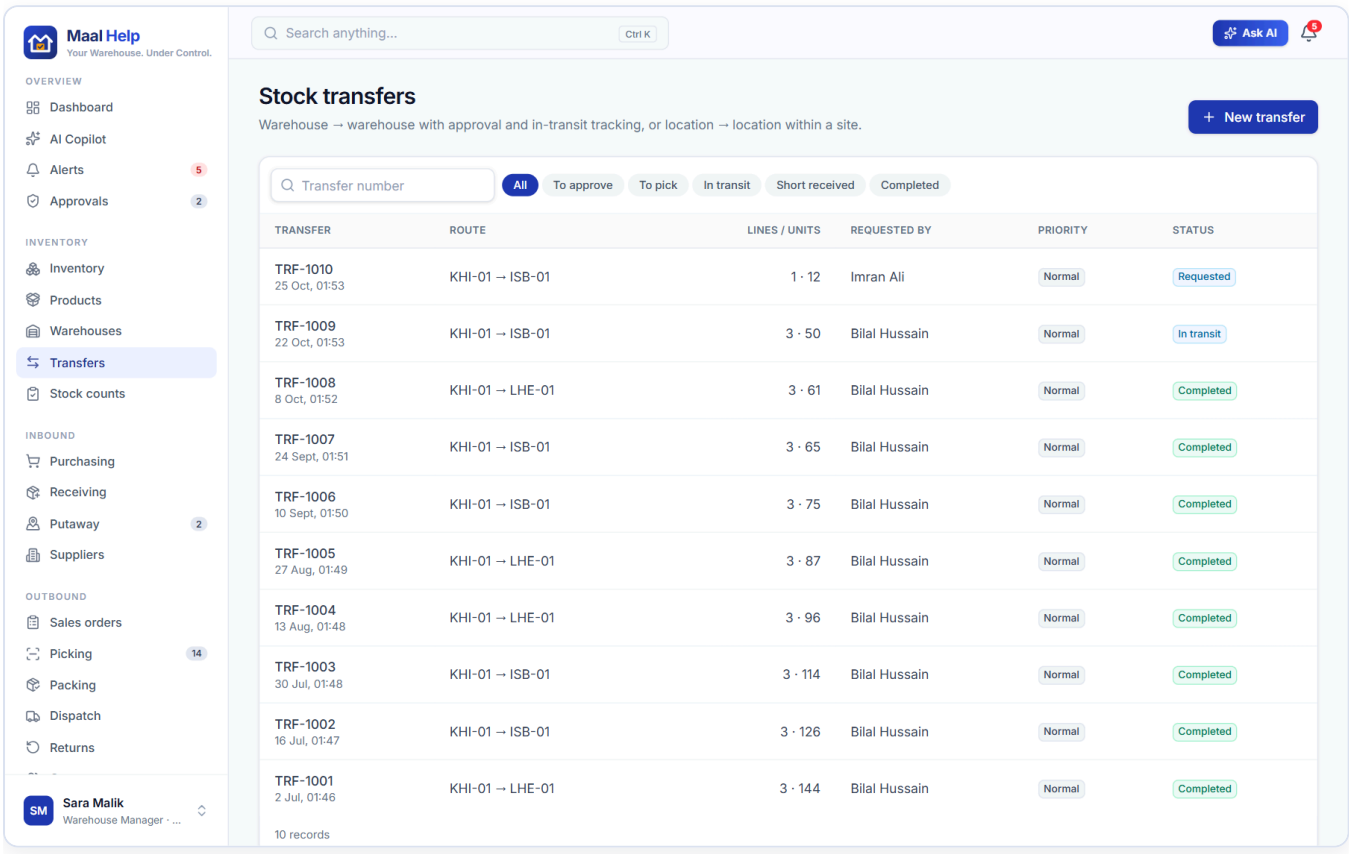


Figure 7. Transfers by status: To approve, To pick, In transit, Short received, Completed.

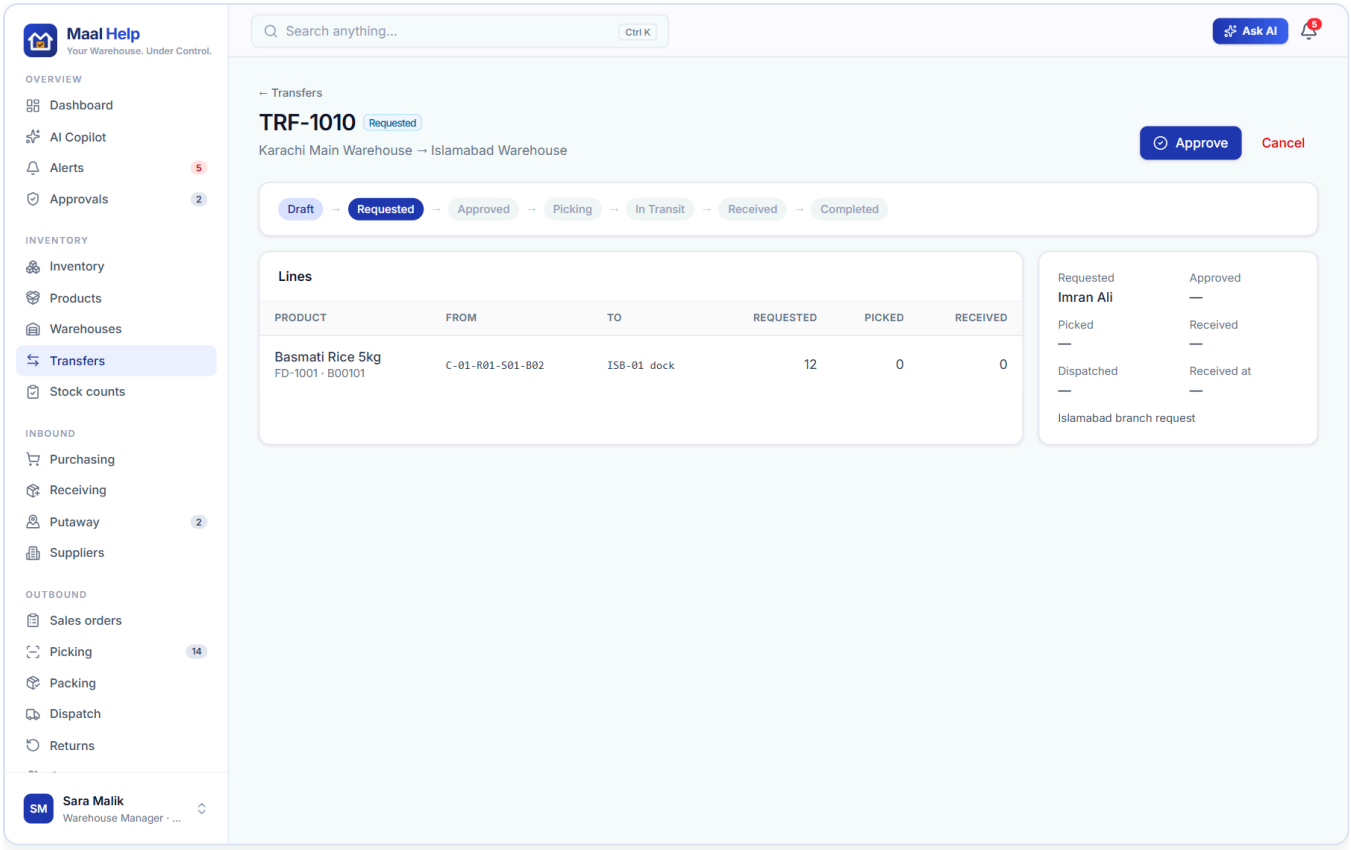


Figure 8. A transfer with its lines and progress.

1. Open **Transfers** → **New transfer**. Choose warehouse or location transfer, source and destination, products and quantities.
2. An approver approves it (if required).
3. The source team picks and **dispatches**: stock becomes **In transit** and cannot be sold.
4. The destination team **receives** it. Any shortage is recorded as *Short received* for investigation.

> You cannot approve a transfer you requested yourself.

Products

The product master: SKUs, barcodes, units, dimensions, prices, reorder levels and tracking rules (batch, expiry, serial).

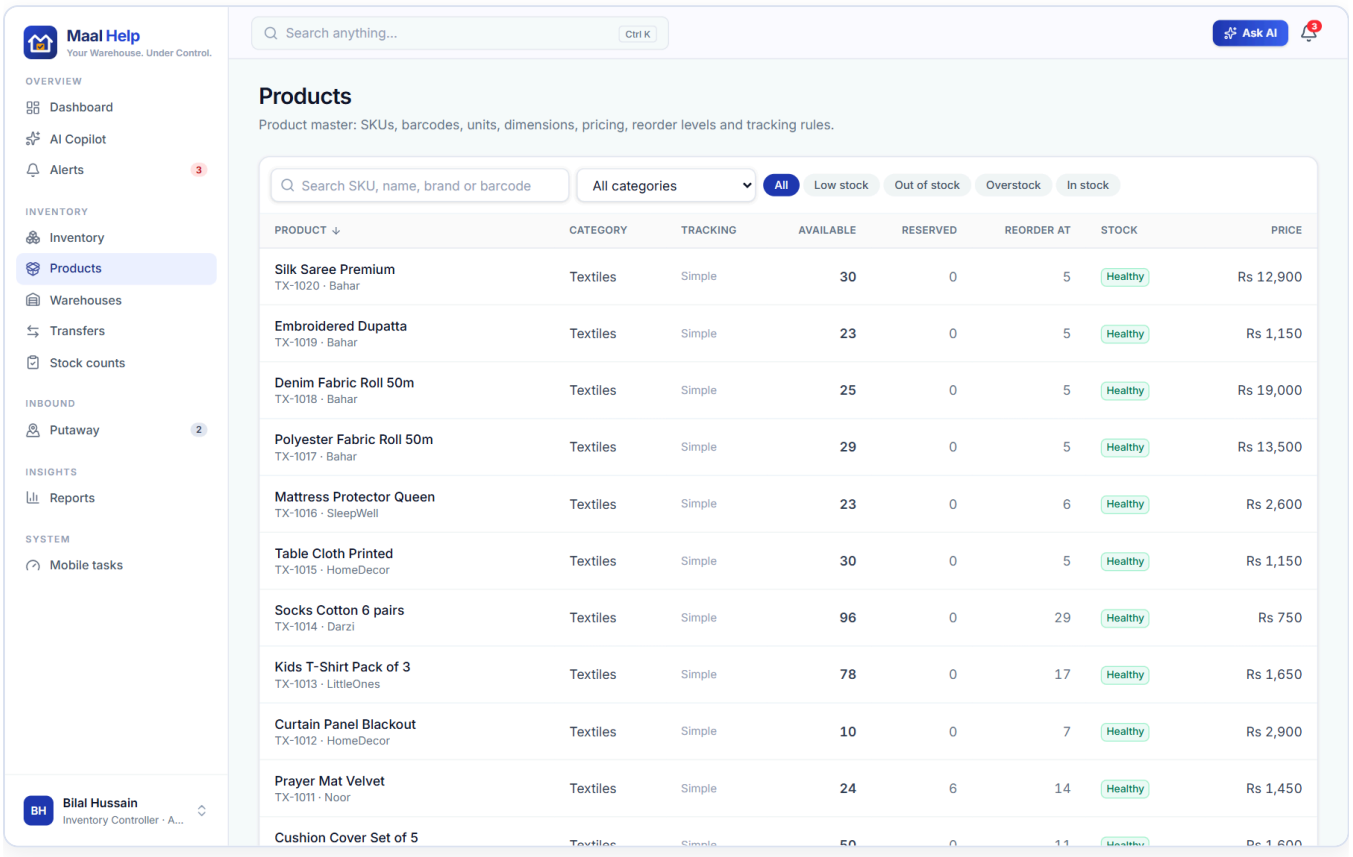


Figure 9. Product list with quick filters: Low stock, Out of stock, Overstock, In stock.

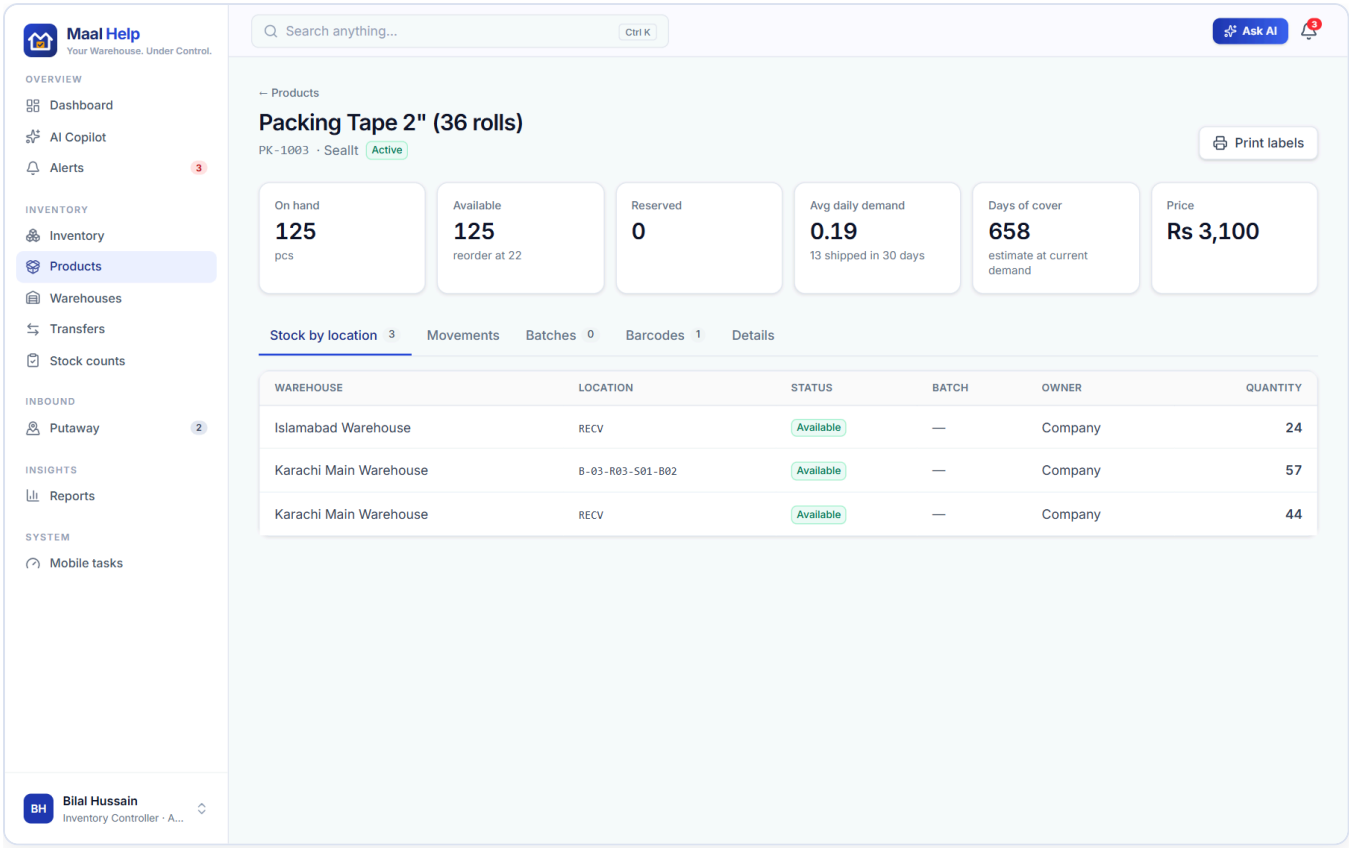


Figure 10. A product record with stock, barcodes and history.

1. Open **Products**. Use the filters or search.
2. **New product**: enter SKU, name, category, unit, barcode (or generate one), dimensions and weight, cost and selling price, tax, reorder level and quantity, and tracking rules.
3. **Import** loads many products from Excel/CSV (see Importing data).
4. Open a product to edit it, print labels or view stock and movements.

> Internal barcodes are EAN-13 numbers in the 29x in-store range, so they never clash with retail barcodes.

Putaway

Move received stock from the dock into storage. Maal Help recommends the best location and explains why.

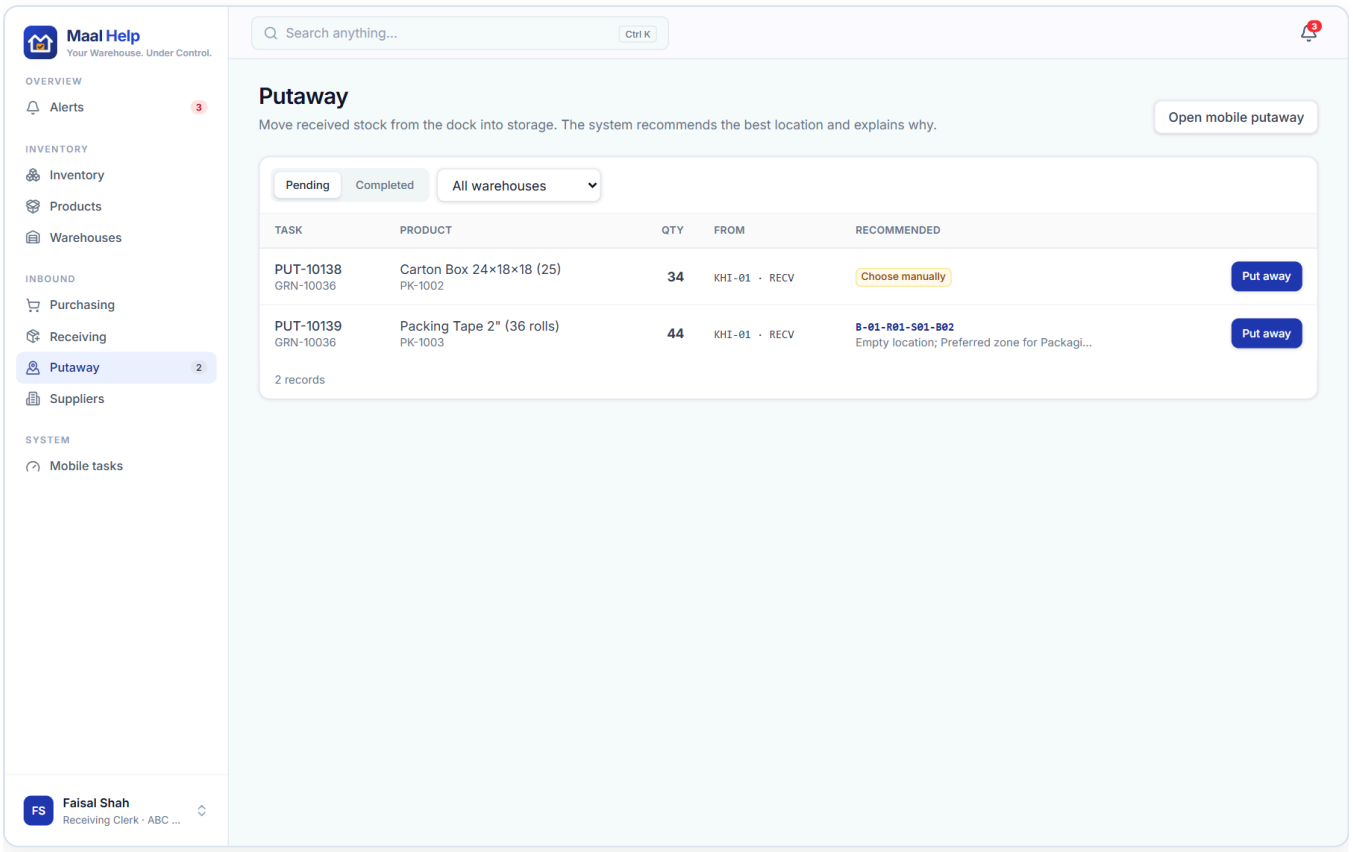


Figure 11. Pending putaway tasks with the recommended location.

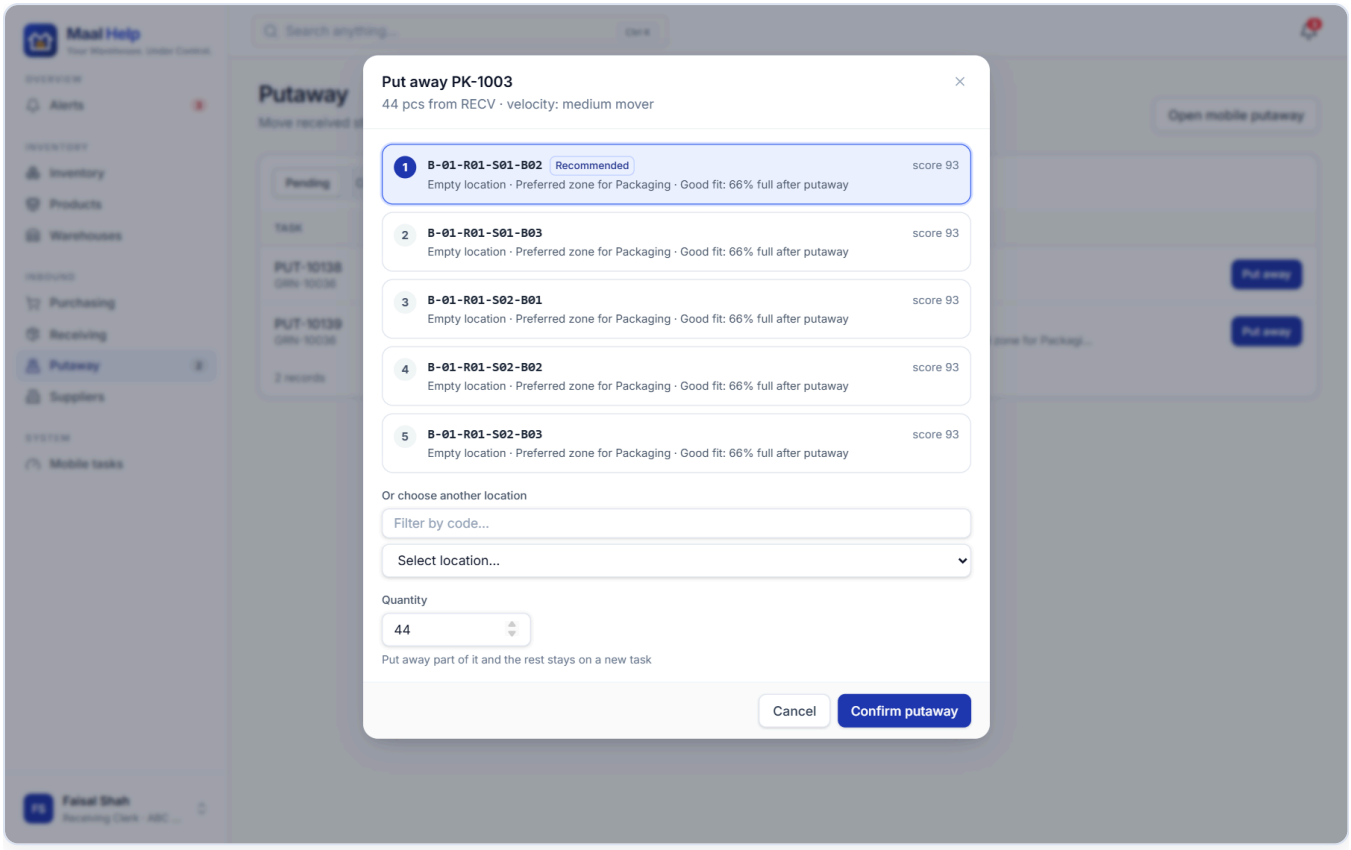


Figure 12. Ranked suggestions with reasons, or choose another location.

1. Open **Putaway** (or **PUTAWAY** on the phone).
2. Select **Put away** on a task. The top suggestion is marked **Recommended**, with reasons such as preferred zone, empty bin, or good fit.
3. Take the goods to the location and confirm. To use another bin, choose it and enter a reason; overrides are recorded.
4. Put away part of the quantity if needed. The rest stays on a new task.

> Stock at the dock cannot be sold until it is put away.

Alert center

Alerts tell you what needs action: low or out-of-stock items, expiring batches, full warehouses, delayed orders and overdue payments. You see only alerts your role may act on.

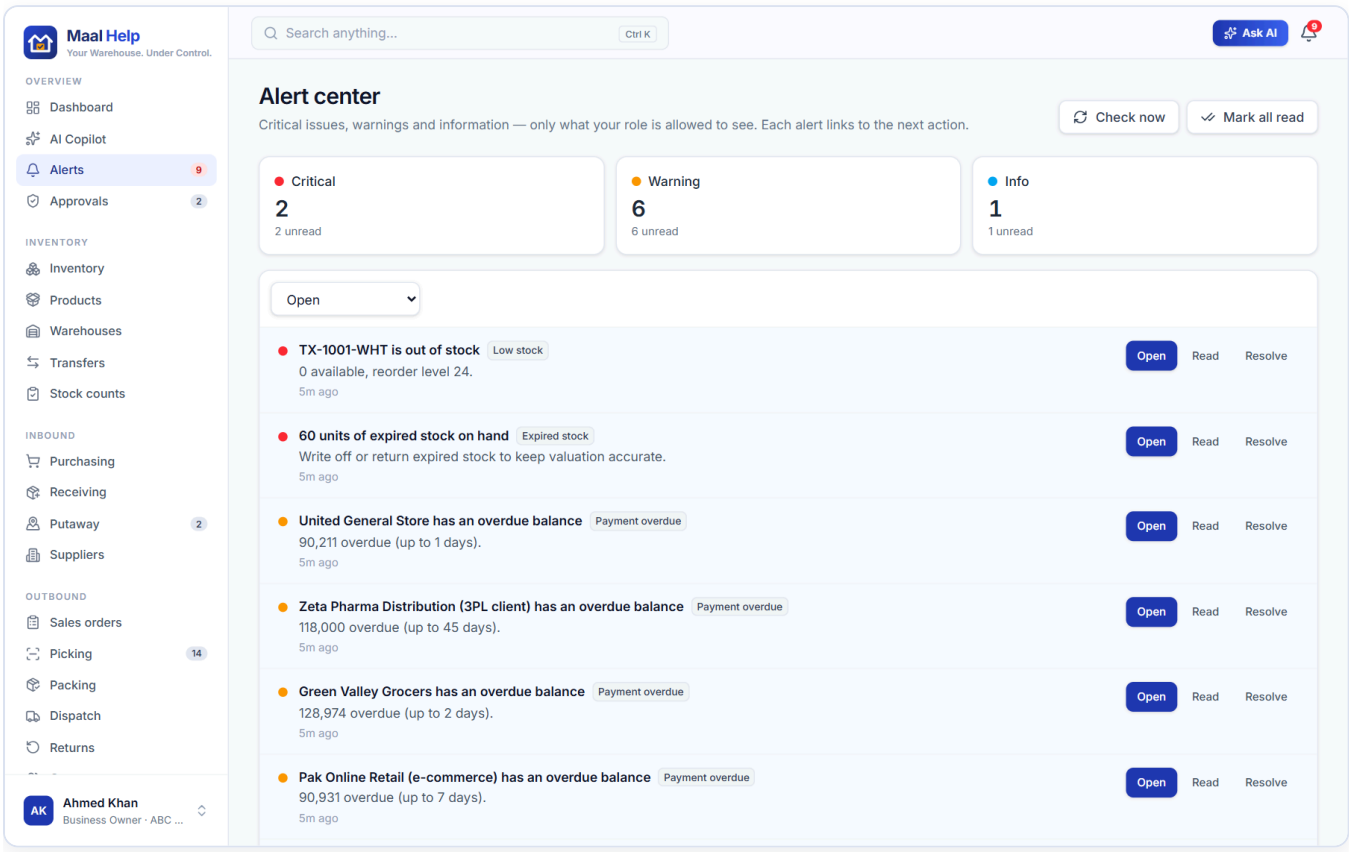


Figure 13. Alert center grouped by Critical, Warning and Info.

1. Open **Alerts** from the sidebar or the bell.
2. Filter by **Critical**, **Warning** or **Info**.
3. Use **Open** to go to the related record, **Read** to mark it seen, and **Resolve** when it is handled.
4. **Check now** re-evaluates alert conditions immediately (alerts are also checked automatically in the background).

AI Copilot

Ask questions in plain English. The Copilot looks up facts with read-only tools limited to what your role may see, and shows its sources. It can recommend; you decide.

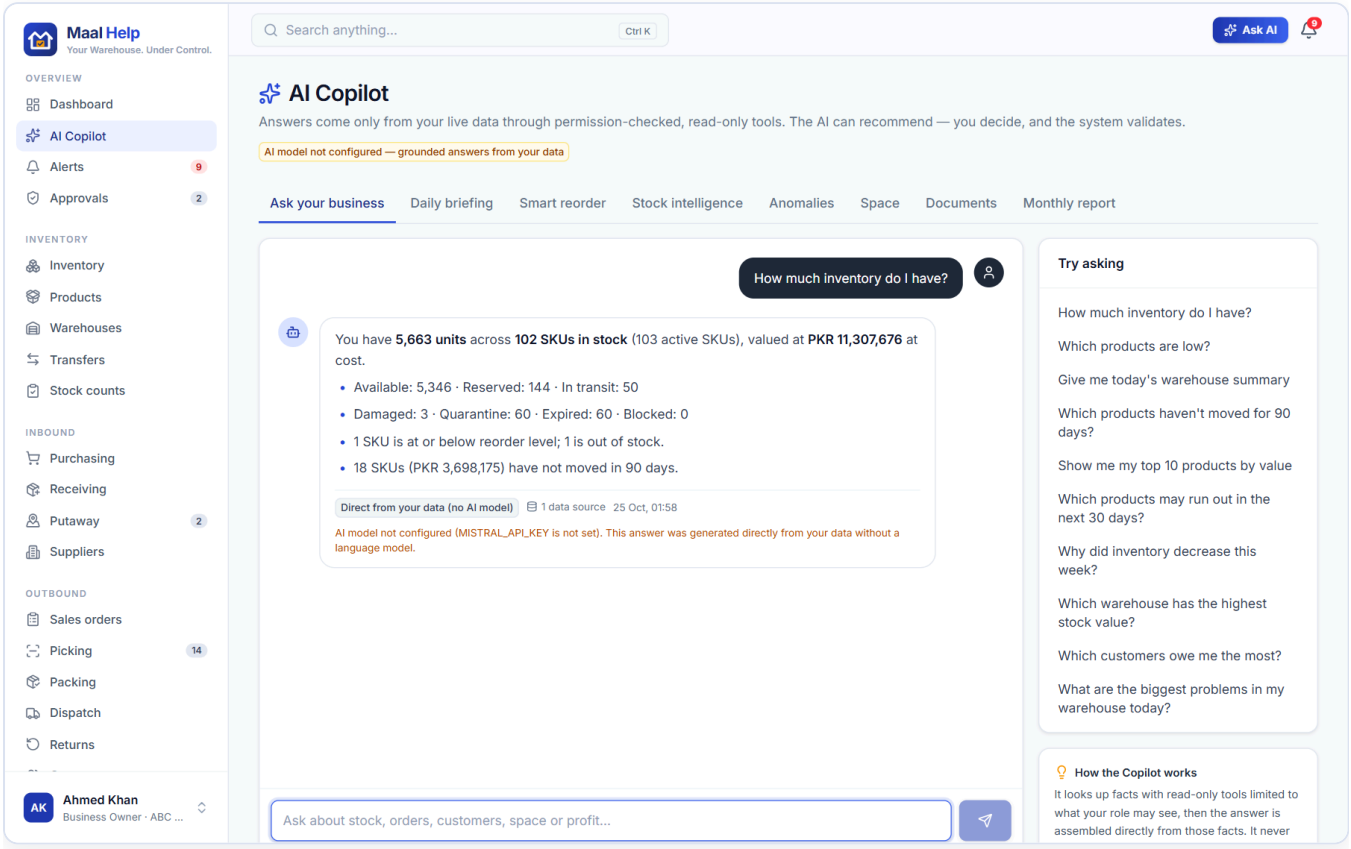


Figure 14. An answer built from live data, with its data source and mode shown.

1. Open **AI Copilot** (or select **Ask AI**).
2. Type a question, for example *How much inventory do I have?*, *Which products are low?* or *Which customers owe me the most?*, or tap a suggestion.
3. Check the badge under the answer: **Mistral AI · from your data** or **Direct from your data (no AI model)**. Open *data sources* to see what was used.
4. Other tabs: **Daily briefing**, **Smart reorder**, **Stock intelligence**, **Anomalies**, **Space**, **Documents**, **Monthly report**.

> The AI never changes stock, approves anything or posts financial entries. Suggested purchase orders open as drafts that a person must review and save.

> If your company has not configured the AI model, answers are assembled directly from your data and are clearly labelled.

> Anomalies are flags for review, never accusations. Write your findings when you mark one reviewed.

Reports and exports

35 reports in five groups: Inventory, Warehouse, Sales, Purchasing and Financial. Every report supports filters, search, sorting, paging, Excel/CSV/PDF export and printing.

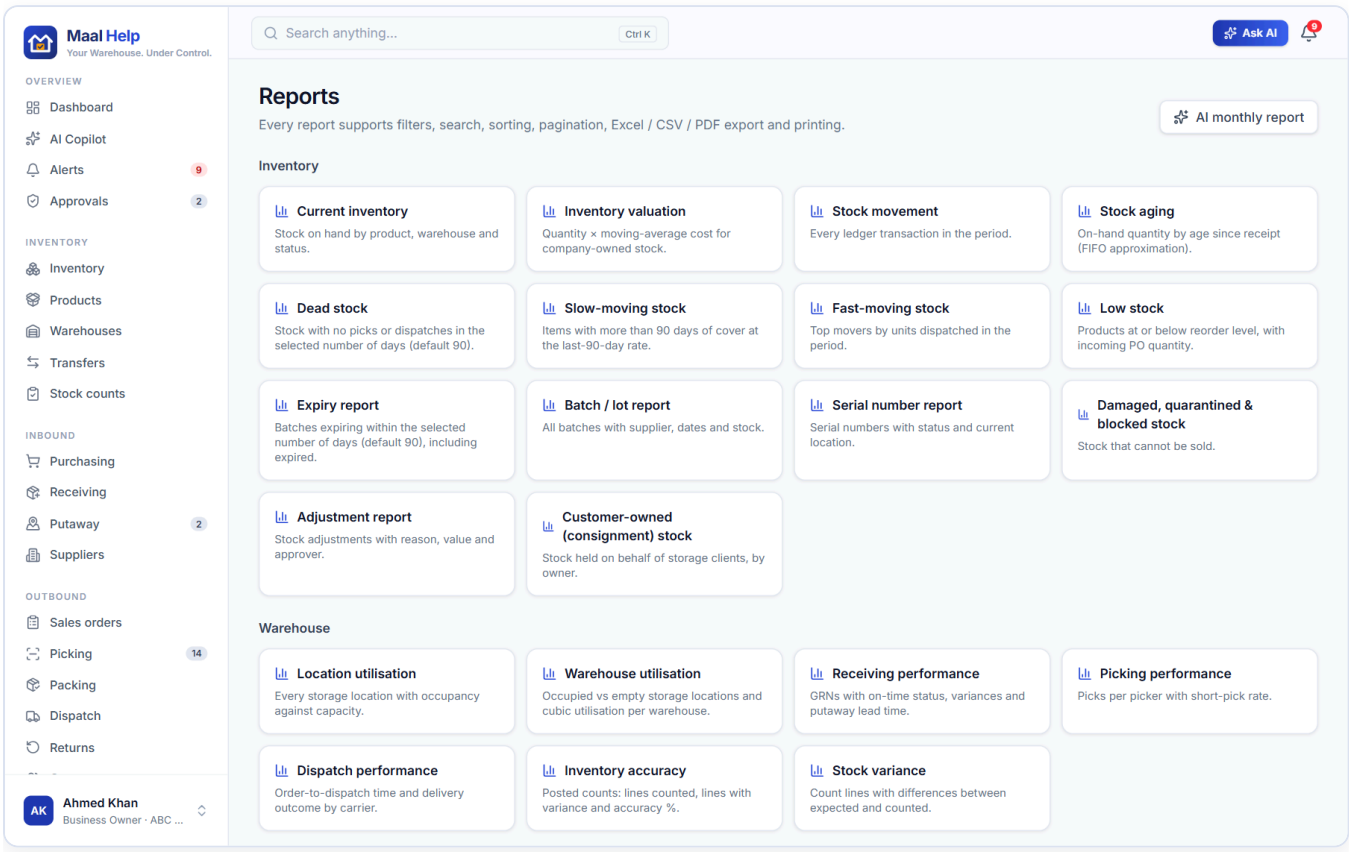


Figure 15. The report library.

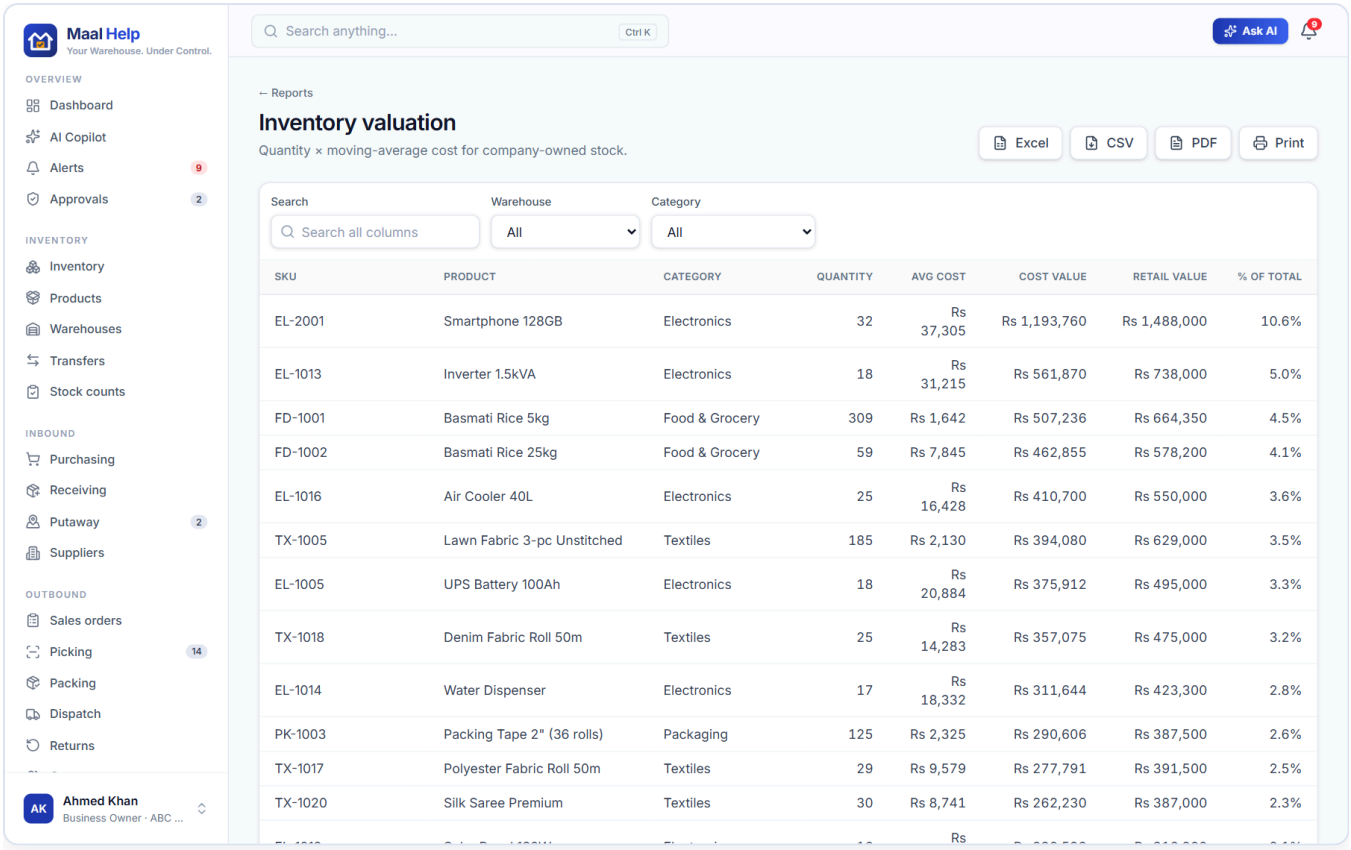


Figure 16. Inventory valuation with filters and export.

1. Open **Reports** and choose a report. You see only reports your role may view.
2. Set filters (dates, warehouse, product, customer…) and search or sort the table.
3. Export with **Excel**, **CSV** or **PDF**, or print. PDFs carry the Maal Help letterhead.
4. **AI monthly report** gives a written business summary for a month.

5 End-to-end workflows

Weekly cycle count

1. Create a **cycle** count for one zone (blind if possible).
2. Assign a counter; they count on the phone.
3. Review variances; investigate large ones before submitting for approval.

Quarantine a damaged batch

1. Find the batch in **Inventory** → **Batches & expiry**.
2. Change status to **quarantine** or **damaged** with a reason.
3. Report it to the manager; write off later through an approved adjustment.

6 Reports, notifications and exceptions

Reports and exports

Current inventory, Stock movement, Batch, Serial, Expiry, Damaged stock, Adjustments, Inventory accuracy, Stock variance.

Open **Reports**, choose a report, set filters and export to Excel, CSV or PDF, or print. You see only the reports your role may view.

Notifications and alerts

Low stock, expiry and variance alerts.

The bell at the top right lists new notifications. In-app alerts are always on; email and WhatsApp alerts depend on your company's settings.

When something is refused

Message	Meaning	What to do
Insufficient stock	Not enough *available* units at that place	Check reserved, quarantine or dock stock; choose another location or wait
Wrong location / wrong product	The scan does not match the task	Go to the right place or item and scan again
Quantity exceeds the task	More than required	Enter the task quantity
Pending approval	Above the company threshold	An approver must approve; nothing is posted yet
You don't have permission	Your role lacks the action	Ask your administrator
Credit limit exceeded	Customer balance too high	Collect payment or ask the owner

7 FAQ and troubleshooting

Frequently asked questions

My adjustment says Pending approval

Its value is above the threshold. It posts when a manager approves it.

Why can’t I see a menu or button?

Your role does not include that permission. Ask your administrator. Permissions are checked by the server.

Can I edit or delete a posted stock movement?

No. History is permanent. Corrections are new transactions (an adjustment or reversal) with a reason, so the audit trail stays complete.

Why does the screen say stock is not available?

It may be reserved for another order, in quarantine, damaged, expired, in transit or still at the receiving dock waiting for putaway.

Is my data visible to other companies?

No. Every company’s data is isolated, and requests for another company’s records are refused.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Counted quantity differs every time	Check for unposted putaway tasks or open picks at that location before counting.
“Missing anti-forgery header” or 403 when saving	Refresh the page. If it persists, you may lack permission for the action.
Account locked	Too many wrong passwords. Wait a few minutes or ask your administrator to reset your password.

> Still stuck? Note the screen, the record number (for example SO-10245) and the exact message, and contact your company administrator.

8 Glossary and quick reference

Quick reference

I want to...	Go to
Count	**Stock counts → New count**
Adjust	**Inventory → Adjustments**
History of a product	**Inventory → Movement ledger**
Search anything	**Ctrl + K**

Glossary

Term	Meaning
SKU	Stock-keeping unit: one product code.
GRN	Goods received note: the record of a delivery received.
PO	Purchase order to a supplier.
SO	Sales order from a customer.
Putaway	Moving received goods from the dock into a storage location.
FEFO	First-expiry-first-out: older-expiry batches are reserved and picked first.
Reserved	Units promised to a confirmed order; not available for other orders.
Quarantine	Units held for inspection; not sellable.
In transit	Units dispatched on a transfer but not yet received.
Ledger	The permanent, append-only list of every stock movement.
Wave	A group of pick tasks picked together (batch or zone).
Back-order	The part of an order that could not be reserved yet.
3PL / storage client	A business whose goods you store and bill for storage and handling.
NTN / STRN	Pakistan national tax number / sales tax registration number.
Blind count	A count where the counter does not see the expected quantity.